

Australia

Ratio: 2:1 **Adopted:** May 29, 1909 **Usage:** National and Civil

The Union Jack is retained in the canton



The stars of the Southern Cross

The points of the "Commonwealth Star" represent the members of the Federation

Australasia and Oceania



The great southern continent of **Australia** was unified in 1901, as a commonwealth of six formerly separate British subject states.

The first national flag was adopted in 1901 following various design competitions, but its use was restricted. It includes a blue ensign and three motifs, celebrating key aspects of Australian statehood.

THE SOUTHERN CROSS

This constellation is visible throughout the year in southern night skies and has been used as a navigational aid for centuries. It helped guide early European ships to the continent and became a popular emblem for the new settlers. The five stars of the cross appear on the fly, with seven points for the brightest stars and five for the lesser Epsilon Crucis.

THE UNION JACK

First flown on Australian soil by Captain Cook, it was the national flag from 1788 and remained the official citizens' land flag until 1954. It occupies the canton, denoting Australia's historical links with Great Britain.

THE "COMMONWEALTH STAR"

This large star affirms the federal nature of government in Australia. Originally there were six points for the six federal states. The seventh point was added in 1909, to represent the Northern Territory together with the six other external territories administered by the Australian Federal Government.